

Delaware County Budget Hearing AM session - September 22nd, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=EJ3LHJ6H5Kg
Publication Date	2026-09-23T03:51:44Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting Body: County Council / Commissioners

Document Type: Comprehensive Civic Analysis & Meeting Record

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

No statutory public hearing or separate committee session was held immediately prior to the regular meeting call to order. This section is omitted in accordance with the report guidelines.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** The meeting began with discussions surrounding budget sheets, revenue projections, and long-range financial forecasting **00:00:00**.
- **Attendance:** Specific roll call details for all individual members were not explicitly stated at the outset. However, participants engaging in the discussion and recognized by name or title include:
 - Presiding Officer / Council President
 - Commissioner Jim (Jim Brand / Board Member)

- Fred (Public Safety / Communications)
 - Candy Abbott (County Assessor's Office)
 - Jane Smith (Delaware County Recorder)
 - Staff / Financial representatives including Matt and Tanya.
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3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The transcript begins directly mid-deliberation on administrative budget sheets, omitting standard ceremonial openings such as the invocation or Pledge of Allegiance.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** Prior meeting minutes were not formally addressed or voted upon during the recorded transcript excerpt.
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4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:01:32 Long-Range Revenue Projections & Financial Forecasting**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Financial Analytics (Baker Tilly & Policy Analytics)
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council reviewed revenue and net levy projections for 2027 through 2030. Projections indicated net levies of \$25.5B in 2027, \$26.7B in 2028, \$26.6B in 2029, and \$27.7B in 2030 (accounting for circuit breakers). Fund balances were projected to dip into negative figures in 2028 and 2029 before recovering in 2030. Board members debated the reliability of long-range forecasts, noting uncertainty regarding future expenditures, utilities, and potential economic recessions.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion only; no formal vote taken.
- **00:07:36 Employee Salary Adjustments & Scenarios**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / Auditor's Office
 - **Deliberation Summary:** The council discussed potential salary adjustments for county employees. Auditor data indicated that a 1% across-the-board salary increase (including FICA and PERF) for eligible employees not already receiving adjustments would cost \$189,000 in county general and \$208,073 across all funds. Members debated whether to use one-time "givebacks" (\$964,000+ over mandatory baselines) to fund recurring salary increases, weighing the risk against fluctuating revenues, utility cost spikes, and low operating cash balances.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Consensus reached to direct council members to draft individual salary proposals and reconvene to finalize numbers.
- **00:25:44 Commission Building Repair & Tower Flood Mitigation Budgets**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council Members / Fred (Public Safety)

- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion was held regarding increasing the commission building repair budget from \$250,000 to \$1 million, as well as addressing a \$1.765 million budgetary quote to fortify and raise the communication tower building six feet following flood damage. Staff noted that insurance denied coverage, and hopes rely on upcoming FEMA Public Program meetings or a 2% low-interest loan option.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational discussion; no formal appropriation vote enacted.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **00:27:23 Fred (Public Safety / Communications):** Advocated against a “peanut butter approach” across-the-board raise. Stated that his department is down four positions because surrounding counties pay 10% more to start. Requested the reinstatement of a 5% raise for communications staff to remain competitive in hiring.
 - **00:33:07 Candy Abbott (County Assessor’s Office):** Supported public safety’s staffing concerns, noting that her office struggles to fill low-paying jobs, forces staff to hold second jobs, and has seen appeals triple from 600 last year to 3,700 this year without commensurate pay adjustments compared to neighboring Madison County.
 - **00:36:06 Jane Smith (Delaware County Recorder):** Thanked the council and advocated for a 4% raise for her three full-time staff members who possess 22 to 29 years of experience and are paid out of the recorder perpetuation fund, which fully supports the increase.
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6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - The council scheduled a follow-up work session to review individual salary and budget proposals for **Thursday, October 1st at 9:00 AM** in preparation for budget adoption on October 7th.
 - Staff noted ongoing coordination with the Auditor’s office regarding workers’ compensation calculations (modeled around an average 1% premium impact for full-time staff) and potential adjustments to 40-hour work schedules and building hours.
 - **Adjournment:**
 - **00:47:50** A motion to recess/adjourn until October 1st at 9:00 AM was moved, seconded, and **Approved by Voice Vote (00:48:06)**.
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